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MindHaven

Anonymous Mental Health Support with Real-Time Chat

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Abstract

MindHaven is a web-based mental health platform designed to support both anonymous and registered users. It features real-time private chat with counsellors, self-assessment tools, and curated resources. The system aims to provide accessible, secure, and user-friendly support, especially for those hesitant to seek help in person.

Introduction

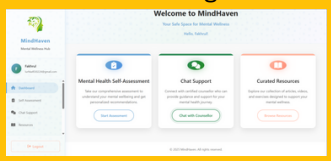
Mental health problems are widespread but many avoid seeking help due to stigma and privacy worries. MindHaven offers anonymous online support with real-time chat, self-assessments, and mental health resources. This platform aims to provide a safe, easy way for users to access help and information.

Objectives

- To design a web-based mental health support platform for both anonymous and registered users
- To integrate real-time private chat with a counsellor using Ably, plus feedback, tips of the day, and self assessment history features
- To test key functionalities ensure usability and responsiveness

Results

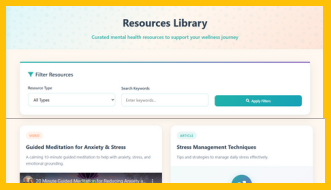
Home Page



Chat Service

Self-Assessment Tools

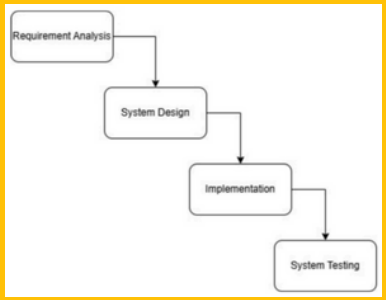
Resources Library



App Features

- **Anonymous & Registered Login**:
  Access with or without an account.
- **Real-Time Counsellor Chat**:
  Private 1-to-1 support via Ably.
- **PHQ-9 & GAD-7 Tests**:
  Self-assessments with saved history.
- **Resource Library**:
  Search, filter, and save mental health content.
- **Dashboards**:
  Tools for admins and counsellors to manage and support users.

Methodology



Waterfall Methodology

1. **Requirement Analysis**

Techniques: Literature review, journals, articles
Outcome: Gathered needs, defined requirements

2. **System Design**

Tools: Diagrams, UI mockups, ERD
Outcome: Structured system flow and layout

3. **Implementation**

Tools: PHP, MySQL, Bootstrap, Ably API
Outcome: Functional system with chat, self-tests, and resources

4. **System Testing**

Techniques: Functionality testing
Outcome: Verified features, improved usability

Conclusion

MindHaven makes mental health support private, accessible, and user-friendly, especially for individuals hesitant to seek help openly. By offering anonymous access, real-time chat with a counsellor, and self-assessment tools, the platform empowers users to take the first step toward better mental health in a safe and supportive environment.